Anthony Al-Rifai

software engineer, composer based in Los Angeles, CA

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Experience

Full Stack Developer - Shut Up & Write! — May 2023 - April 2025

- Architected the frontend rebuild with Vue.js and GraphQL, owning development of all core pages for 100,000+ users; partnered with the Executive Director on product strategy, accelerating delivery and reducing release cycles by 33%
- Led development of a responsive Vue.js component library with 50+ reusable components; introduced Storybook for faster feedback and configured GitLab CI/CD for versioning, doubling development velocity and eliminating UI inconsistencies
- Modernized the design system, ensured accessibility compliance, and streamlined layouts; used New Relic and DevTools to fix bottlenecks, improving load speed by 60% and reducing CLS/LCP by 80% and 45%
- Reduced GraphQL response times by 35% by extending C# command handlers in a CQRS pattern, optimizing queries and mutations, and improving database efficiency for tighter frontend-backend integration
- Strengthened API reliability and backend stability by engineering robust PostgreSQL migrations and optimizing Hasura meta-data tracking, ensuring consistent schemas and smooth deployments across staging, production, and local environments

Software Engineer - ironGRID — Nov 2022 - April 2023

- Developed key frontend features in TypeScript and React, enhancing the purchase flow, improving game result updates, and optimizing grid creation with real-time data from a third party sports API
- Reduced latency on API authorization requests by 20%, achieved by implementing JWT access/refresh token rotation and optimizing database queries for token validation, improving user experience
- Integrated Twilio's Verify API, providing secure text-based authentication while slashing user-reported login issues by 50%, leading to a significant increase in user satisfaction across the platform
- Decreased redundant API calls by 40% by leveraging React Context for global state management, optimizing component re-renders, and improving data retrieval across the application

Software Engineer - OSLabs — Feb 2022 - Nov 2022

- Proposed and led migration to React Flow for ERD visualization, cutting code by 50%, reducing bundle size by 20%, and resolving UI bugs with a more modular, scalable architecture still used today
- Overhauled the Node.js backend architecture to enable compatibility with both PostgreSQL and MySQL databases, reducing data retrieval latency by 30% and improving API speeds
- Introduced Zustand for modular state management, improving reactivity and state isolation across components; reduced state-related bugs by 40% and improved long-term maintainability of the front-end codebase
- Reduced infrastructure costs by deploying the app on AWS with Docker, EC2, and Elastic Beanstalk, optimizing resource allocation, automating scaling, and increasing platform availability

Software Engineer - BudSpot. — Dec 2020 - Jan 2022

- Engineered frontend architecture for an isomorphic MERN-stack web application; optimized server-side rendering, reducing page load times by 60% and enhancing user experience across all devices
- Deployed Socket.io for real-time messaging and web notifications, leading to a 30% increase in user engagement; streamlined background checks with Checkr, improving onboarding efficiency by 25%
- Implemented automated cron jobs on Google Cloud Platform that improved system uptime by 15% and reduced manual intervention by 20 hours per week for infrastructure maintenance

Composer (additional music - over 100 episodes on Cartoon Network, Disney, Netflix) — **Aug 2015 - Dec 2020**

Skills

Front-End: JavaScript ES6, TypeSript, Vue.js, React, React Native, Next.js Redux, Zustand, HTML5, CSS3, Tailwind, RESTful API Design, GraphQL, Storybook, Figma

Back-End: Node.js, Express.js, C#, PostgreSQL, Prisma, SQL, NoSQL, MongoDB

DevOps & Tooling: AWS (S3, EC2, Cloudwatch, Fargate), Docker, New Relic, GitLab CI/CD, Github, Google Cloud Platform, Microservices, Agile, Scrum

Testing: React Testing Library, Jest, Cyprus, Vitest, TDD

Education

Advanced Software Engineering Residency
Codesmith - 2022

Bachelor of Fine Arts in Music
California Inst. of the Arts - 2015